

# ■# PAPER\_317: Orion M42 Trapezium Wind Ram Pressure Dominance

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$\eta_{\text{wind}} = 28.47$  |  $t_{\text{erosion}} = 467 \text{ kyr}$  |  $a_{\text{wind}} = 5.424 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m/s}^2$

**FIRST UQFF HII Region Ram Pressure Dominance Ratio**

**Session:** 91 **Module:** ORIONUQFFMODULE.cpp (33rd C++ module) **System:** Orion Nebula M42/NGC 1976 — compact HII region, Trapezium OB cluster ionization source **Watermark:** Copyright — Daniel T. Murphy, Session 91, March 2026

<!-- UQFF constants:  $\kappa = 5.0\text{e-}4 \text{ day}^{-1}$ ,  $[\text{SSq}] = 0.57$ ,  $M_{\text{UQFF}} = 1.43\text{e}1 \text{ TeV}$  -->

## Abstract

Within the UQFF framework, this paper quantifies the ram pressure dominance of the Trapezium-driven stellar wind over self-gravity in the Orion Nebula. The dimensionless wind-gravity ratio  $\eta_{\text{wind}} = P_{\text{ram}}/P_{\text{grav}} = 28.47$  demonstrates that the HII region was born in a wind-dominated (unbound) state. The erosion timescale  $t_{\text{erosion}} = 467 \text{ kyr}$  shows that protoplanetary discs (proplyds) currently observed at  $\sim 300 \text{ kyr}$  age survive inside a wind-dominated environment. This is the FIRST UQFF computation of an HII region ram pressure dominance ratio.

## System Parameters

| Parameter             | Value                                                               | Description                      |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| M                     | $2000 M_{\text{sun}} = 3.978 \times 10^{33} \text{ kg}$             | Total nebular mass               |
| r                     | $1.18 \times 10^{17} \text{ m}$ (~12.5 ly)                          | Half-span                        |
| $\rho_{\text{fluid}}$ | $1 \times 10^{-20} \text{ kg/m}^3$                                  | HII gas density                  |
| $v_{\text{wind}}$     | $8 \times 10^3 \text{ m/s}$                                         | Ionization front expansion speed |
| $t_{\text{age}}$      | $3 \times 10^5 \text{ yr} = 9.467 \times 10^{12} \text{ s}$         | Nebula age                       |
| G                     | $6.6743 \times 10^{-11} \text{ m}^3 \text{ kg}^{-1} \text{ s}^{-2}$ | Gravitational constant           |

## Key Equations

### Base Gravity

$$g_{\text{base}} = \frac{GM}{r^2} = \frac{6.6743 \times 10^{-11} \times 3.978 \times 10^{33}}{(1.18 \times 10^{17})^2} = 1.907 \times 10^{-11} \text{ m/s}^2$$

### Ram Pressure Acceleration ( $t = 0$ )

$$a_{\text{wind}}(t=0) = \frac{v_{\text{wind}}^2}{r} = \frac{(8 \times 10^3)^2}{1.18 \times 10^{17}} = 5.424 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m/s}^2$$

### Ram Pressure Acceleration ( $t = t_{\text{age}}$ )

$$a_{\text{wind}}(t_{\text{age}}) = \frac{v_{\text{wind}}^2}{r} \left( 1 + \frac{t_{\text{age}}}{t_{\text{age}}} \right) = 2 \times 5.424 \times 10^{-10} = 1.085 \times 10^{-9} \text{ m/s}^2$$

### Ram Pressure (Pa)

$$P_{\text{ram}} = \rho \cdot v_{\text{wind}}^2 = 10^{-20} \times (8 \times 10^3)^2 = 6.4 \times 10^{-13} \text{ Pa}$$

### Gravitational Pressure (Pa)

$$P_{\text{grav}} = \frac{GM\rho}{r} = \frac{6.6743 \times 10^{-11} \times 3.978 \times 10^{33}}{1.18 \times 10^{17}} = 2.248 \times 10^{-14} \text{ Pa}$$

### Wind–Gravity Dominance Ratio (PAPER\_317 Key Result)

$$\eta_{\text{wind}} = \frac{P_{\text{ram}}}{P_{\text{grav}}} = \frac{a_{\text{wind}}}{g_{\text{base}}} = \frac{5.424 \times 10^{-10}}{1.907 \times 10^{-11}} = \boxed{28.47}$$

### Erosion Timescale

$$t_{\text{erosion}} = \frac{r}{v_{\text{wind}}} = \frac{1.18 \times 10^{17}}{8 \times 10^3} = 4.675 \times 10^{13} \text{ s} = \boxed{467 \text{ kyr}}$$

### Kinetic-to-Gravitational Energy Ratio

$$\frac{W_{\text{KE}}}{W_{\text{grav}}} \approx \frac{a_{\text{wind}}}{g_{\text{base}}} = 28.47$$

## Results Summary

| Quantity                             | Value                                 | Significance                        |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| $g_{\text{base}}$                    | $1.907 \times 10^{-11} \text{ m/s}^2$ | Newtonian self-gravity              |
| $a_{\text{wind}}(t=0)$               | $5.424 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m/s}^2$ | Initial ram pressure                |
| $\eta_{\text{wind}}(t=0)$            | <b>28.47</b>                          | Wind >> gravity at birth            |
| $a_{\text{wind}}(t_{\text{age}})$    | $1.085 \times 10^{-9} \text{ m/s}^2$  | Ram pressure at 300 kyr             |
| $\eta_{\text{wind}}(t_{\text{age}})$ | <b>56.9</b>                           | Wind dominance doubles              |
| $t_{\text{erosion}}$                 | <b>467 kyr</b>                        | Proplyd lifetime > $t_{\text{age}}$ |
| $P_{\text{ram}}$                     | $6.4 \times 10^{-13} \text{ Pa}$      | Ram pressure                        |
| $P_{\text{grav}}$                    | $2.248 \times 10^{-14} \text{ Pa}$    | Gravitational pressure              |

## UQFF Physical Interpretation

The Orion Nebula at  $t_{\text{age}} = 300 \text{ kyr}$  is still **28.5–57× wind-dominated** ( $\eta_{\text{wind}}$  ranging from 28.47 at  $t=0$  to 56.9 at  $t_{\text{age}}$ ). The erosion timescale  $t_{\text{erosion}} = 467 \text{ kyr} > t_{\text{age}} = 300 \text{ kyr}$  confirms that proplyds currently observed by HST survive because they have not yet been fully ablated by the ram pressure — consistent with observational evidence of ~150–180 proplyds in the Orion Nebula.

**UQFF Significance:** This is the FIRST UQFF quantification of wind ram pressure dominance over self-gravity in a compact HII region. The wind term  $a_{\text{wind}}(t) = v_{\text{wind}}^2/r \times (1+t/t_{\text{age}})$  [registered as WOLFRAMTERMORIONWINDRAM in ORIONUQFFMODULE.cpp] dominates the gravitational term by a factor of 28.47 at birth, growing to 56.9 at 300 kyr — placing Orion in the same UQFF "wind-dominant" class as post-AGB bipolar PNe but via HII ionization physics rather than stellar wind shocks.

## WOLFRAM\_TERM Registration

```
#define WOLFRAM_TERM_ORION_WIND_RAM(val) (val)
// wind = v_wind^2/r * (1+t/t_age) [PAPER_317 ram pressure dominance; eta_wind=28.47]
```

Series first: *FIRST UQFF HII region ram pressure dominance ratio. Distinguishes compact OB-driven HII ( $\eta_{\text{wind}}=28.47$ ) from extended GMC HII and from bipolar PN wind shocks ( $\eta_{\text{wind}}\sim 7\times 10^4$ , PAPER\_311).*